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Source: US Navy

■ A US Navy warship operates near the Strait of Hormuz as tensions with Iran keep one of the world's busiest energy corridors under close military watch.

UAE calls for immediate halt to hostilities in the region

Foreign Ministry warns Iranian aggression endangers regional security and stability

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE expressed its deep concern over the developments that the region has witnessed over the past few days, and has called for an immediate halt to the escalation and to avoid exacerbating tensions and instability in the region.

The UAE called for exercising the utmost restraint in order to avoid dangerous repercussions, and the region being pulled into new levels of violence and instability.

Return to negotiations

The UAE called for an immediate end to hostilities and a swift return to negotiations and stressed the importance of ensuring safe, uninterrupted navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, calling it vi-

The UAE stressed the importance of ensuring safe, uninterrupted navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, calling it vital to the global economy.

tal to the global economy. The UAE emphasised that the targeting of civilian infrastructure and civilian facilities in the region, including schools, universities, hospitals, desalination plants, energy facilities, transportation hubs, and residential areas constitute a flagrant and grave violation of the established principles and provisions of international law, and cannot, under any circumstances, be accepted or justified.

UAE condemns Iran attacks

The UAE also condemned in the strongest terms the renewed hostile attacks by Iran targeting Bahrain, Kuwait,

and Jordan with missiles and drones, according to WAM.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) affirmed that these hostile attacks constitute a flagrant violation of the sovereignty of the brotherly nations and a threat to their security and stability.

The Ministry reiterated the UAE's full solidarity with Bahrain, Kuwait, and Jordan, and its support for all measures aimed at safeguarding their security and stability.

Two US troops killed

Earlier, two US service members were killed and one remained missing after Iranian missile and drone attacks in Jordan, marking the first American military deaths linked to the Iran conflict since March.

Tehran said it would suspend commitments to an interim agreement reached with Washington last month, while Iran's Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei called US President Donald Trump's signature on the deal "worthless".

SEE ALSO P6

Dubai to ensure more residents leave their cars

New initiative aims to create seamless first- and last-mile links

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) has approved a five-year plan to expand Dubai's soft mobility network through 2030, connecting 25 residential communities and upgrading the areas around 63 public transport stations.

The initiative aims to create seamless first- and last-mile links through walking paths, cycling tracks, e-scooter facilities and shared mobility services, enabling residents to complete their journeys more easily and safely, while reduc-

ing dependence on private cars. The project will deliver dedicated pedestrian and cycling infrastructure, safe crossings, shaded walkways, bicycle parking, mobility hubs, pickup and drop-off points, and parking bays for shared mobility services such as Careem Bike and e-scooter operators.

According to the RTA, pedestrian journeys reached 342 million in 2025, up 5 per cent from the previous year, while cycling trips rose by 23 per cent to 57.3 million. E-scooter trips also surged nearly 23 per cent to 39.6 million. The initiative forms part of Dubai's wider strategy to create a connected urban mobility ecosystem where Metro, buses, trams, marine transport, taxis and individual mobility options work together as a single network.

SEE ALSO P2

UAE non-oil trade close to record Dh2tr

FIRST-HALF TRADE RISES 13.1% AS
NON-OIL EXPORTS CLIMB TO DH452.8B

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE's non-oil foreign trade came within reach of the Dh2 trillion mark for the first time in a six-month period, climbing to Dh1.937 trillion in the first half of 2026, while non-oil exports rose to a record Dh452.8 billion.

In a post on X, His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, said non-oil foreign trade grew 13.1 per cent year-on-year, describing the first-half performance as "historic". "These figures are not merely trade data," he wrote. "They reflect the strength of our economy, the effectiveness of our development choices and the world's confidence in the UAE."

In the first half of 2026, the UAE's non-oil foreign trade grew 13.1 per cent compared to the same period in 2025, 39.6 per cent more than the first half of 2024 and 54.5 per cent more than the first half of 2023.

More than double

Non-oil foreign trade in the first half of 2026 more than doubled the levels recorded during the same period in both 2019 and 2021, further underscoring the significant acceleration in national economic growth.

Non-oil exports were the

48.8%

year-on-year growth in gold trade, with a value of Dh706.2b

leading driver of the country's trade performance. They grew 23.9 per cent year-on-year to reach Dh452.8 billion, which is 77.3 per cent more than the first half of 2024.

The share of non-oil exports in the UAE's total non-oil foreign trade climbed to 23.4 per cent, up from 21.3 per cent in the same period of 2025, 18.4 per cent in 2024, and 16.9 per cent in 2023.

Trade with countries covered by the UAE's Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreements (CEPAs) also reached Dh304.3 billion during the first six months. China retained its position as the UAE's largest trading partner with non-oil trade of Dh180.7 billion, followed by Switzerland at Dh138.4 billion, then India at Dh107.5 billion.

Gold remained the leading commodity in UAE non-oil trade, with a value of Dh706.2 billion in H1 2026 for a year-on-year growth of 48.8 per cent. It was followed by the telecoms sector at Dh189.7 billion, then gold jewellery, automobiles and diamonds.

NATION

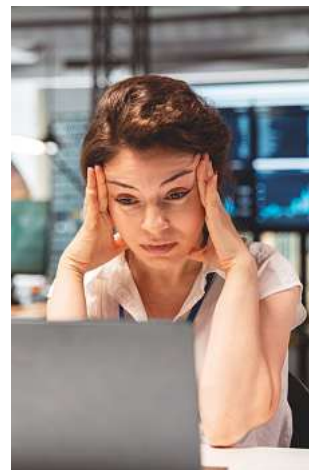
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IN FOCUS

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